The militants linked with the Hakimullah Mehsud-led TTP had been kidnapping for ransom from Waziristan. An important member of TTP from Orakzai Agency, Muhammad Rafiq, whose son had carried out a suicide attack on the Naval Complex Islamabad on 2 December 2009, revealed during interrogation that they had kidnapped at least seven people from the Orakzai Agency and received Rs 10–15 million each.[7]

The Hakimullah-led TTP also demanded huge money from the telecommunication companies and threatened to blow up their communication towers if they did not comply. His spokesperson made these demands by a phone call to the Lahore offices of cellular companies like Mobilink, Warid and Ufone.[8]

Confirmed reports indicated that Taliban were involved in bank robberies in major Pakistani cities such as Karachi, Lahore and Rawalpindi (Pakistan Nationalist Association, 2011). In 2008–9, the Karachi police detected an increase in Taliban-orchestrated bank robberies and kidnappings.

According to the Interior Ministry of Pakistan, 'Of the dozen bank robberies that occurred in Karachi in 2009, 80 per cent could be traced back to individuals based in the tribal areas who are believed to be working for the TTP'. In 2008, officials tracked a heist of Rs 150 million ($1.79 million) from a money exchange company in Karachi to now-deceased TTP leader Baitullah Mehsud. On finding clues, the owners of the money exchange company approached the TTP leadership in Waziristan and asked Mehsud to return the money. Later reports confirmed that Mehsud gave some of the money back.

In a daylight bank robbery, six TTP militants looted Rs 3.5 million from a branch of Habib Bank Limited (HBL) located near Shaukat Khanum Memorial Cancer Hospital & Research Centre in Johar Town on 25 January 2012. According to initial police investigations, the six bandits were Pashtun militants linked with the TTP. The same militants had looted a bank in Lahore in September 2011 (*The Nation*, 2012).

In October 2008, abductors held film producer Satish Anand for six months near Matta, Swat. Jameel Yusuf, a security consultant and former chief of the Citizen Police Liaison Committee, who negotiated Anand's release, said that the Taliban received Rs 1.68 million ($20,016) ransom for this kidnapping. He said that 'The ransom payment was made in Islamabad'. Meanwhile, kidnappers seized two other businessmen. As stated by Yusuf, 'One returned after payment of ransom, while the